IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE "Q"

On July 14, 2026, the City Council voted to place Measure "Q" on the November 3, 2026 general municipal election ballot. By placing Measure "Q" on the ballot, the City of Hemet complies with the California Constitution, which requires a majority of the voters to approve an ordinance that establishes a general tax.

If approved by a majority of Hemet voters, this Measure would authorize a one percent (1%) retail transactions and use (sales) tax within the City of Hemet. A one percent (1%) rate equates to an extra 1¢ per $1 purchased of taxable goods. Exempted from sales tax are unprocessed groceries, rent, prescription medicine and personal services such as medical, dental, and legal. It is estimated that Measure "Q" will provide an additional $16,000,000 in annual local funding that could be used for general City services, including services such as police, fire, paramedic, 911 response, reducing drug-related crime, keeping public areas clean and safe, addressing homelessness, reducing wildfire risks, providing safe and clean drinking water, repairing streets and potholes, maintaining library services, and attracting and retaining businesses. This tax would be a "general tax," meaning that revenues raised from the tax would go into the City's General Fund to pay for any lawful City program, improvement, or service.

California Revenue and Taxation Code section 7285.9 authorizes the City to levy a general transactions and use tax so long as the tax is approved by a majority of the voters voting in an election on that issue. If approved, the tax would remain in effect until ended by Hemet voters voting at a subsequent election. The tax would be paid in addition to sales taxes and would be collected at the same time and in the same manner as existing sales taxes. Measure Q would not amend, extend, replace, or otherwise change the existing Measure H transactions and use tax which would remain in effect. All revenues raised by the tax would remain in the City and would not be shared with the State, County, or any other agency. The receipt and expenditure of tax revenues would be subject to the City's budget process, public financial reporting, and independent annual audits.

A "yes" vote on Measure "Q" will authorize the 1% transactions and use (sales) tax.

A "no" vote on Measure "Q" will not authorize the 1% transactions and use (sales) tax.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of Measure "Q". If you desire a copy of the Measure, please visit https://www.hemetca.gov/1376/Information-About-Measure-Q or call the City Clerk's Office at (951) 765-2395 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you.

By:

Steven Graham Pacifico
City Attorney

Dated: August 17, 2026

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE "Q"

Vote YES on Measure Q to protect Hemet public safety services and maintain the quality of life our residents deserve.

Hemet is one of the few cities in the County with its own Police and Fire Departments. Measure Q is critical to ensuring our police and firefighter/paramedics are available for Hemet residents when needed.

Calls for 911 emergency calls are higher than in the past, and we know response times are critical for saving lives. Crime, drug and gang activity are serious problems in our area, so we need to keep police officers on the streets and fund programs that help keep gang members from nearby communities out of Hemet.

Despite maintaining a balanced budget, state mandates and takeaways have impacted Hemet and we are now using reserves to maintain services. The City has been fiscally responsible, reducing costs and freezing positions, but there is no more room to cut without impacting critical city services, including public safety.

Measure Q helps keep up with basic repairs and maintenance to our roads — repairs that will only get more expensive if we don't address them now.

Clear Accountability and Transparency

- All funds are locally controlled for Hemet services only – the State can't take a penny
- Independent citizens' oversight and annual reports are required
- Essentials like groceries and medicine are exempt

Quality Safety, Quality Services, Quality Hemet:

- Improve 911 emergency and fire response
- Maintain police services, including neighborhood police patrols, and help address homelessness
- Support fire protection services, improve infrastructure, and replace outdated lifesaving and firefighting equipment
- Maintain library services
- Ensure safe, clean drinking water and water infiltration systems
- Repair streets, fix potholes, and keep public areas clean and stop illegal dumping

Join local businesses and neighbors: vote YES on Q!

By: Linda Krupa,
City of Hemet Mayor

Christian Coley,
Hemet Police Officers' Association President

Koka Lakshman,
Director/Chairman of Hemet/San Jacinto Chamber of Commerce

David Prietto,
Hemet City Firefighters' Association, Local 2342 President

Yxstian Gutierrez,
Riverside County 5th District Supervisor

REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE "Q"

The City of Hemet is spending thousands of your tax dollars to convince you to pass yet another tax that can be spent on anything that the Hemet City Council deems worthwhile. They hired an expensive political consulting firm (Fairbank, Maslin, Maulin, Metz & Associates) to carefully craft the "argument" you just read. The sponsors of Measure Q are the heads of the Hemet public safety unions and the Mayor whose last campaign was funded almost entirely by City of Hemet employees. VOTERS SHOULD BE WARY OF SPONSORS WHO WILL DIRECTLY BENEFIT FROM THE PASSAGE OF MEASURE Q.

Why do more than 70 employees at the City of Hemet now have an annual compensation package exceeding $300,000? Because too many City of Hemet Councilmembers place the interests of city employees above those of the citizens they were elected to represent. And where do these extremely well-paid employees live? Almost none live in the City of Hemet. What does that tell you?

Measure Q's sales tax increase to 9.75% will have a disproportionate impact on seniors with fixed incomes. It also places our local businesses at a competitive disadvantage. If you think you can avoid paying the Measure Q tax by purchasing expensive items like vehicles in other cities – think again. Sales taxes on auto purchases are based on the city where you live.

Voters need to ask themselves this simple question: What is the City of Hemet doing wrong that requires us to have the highest sales tax rate out of the 121 cities located in five of the six counties in Southern California?

Enough is Enough!

VOTE NO ON MEASURE Q.

By: James DePasse
Norm Kyriss
Dalila Salcido

ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE "Q"

Definition of insanity --"Doing the same thing, and expecting a different result." In 2016, the Mayor of Hemet promised that if the voters passed an additional 1% sales tax, the City would immediately increase the number of police officers from 65 to 101. Our current "boots on the ground" number is 85, and yet, more than $110,000,000 in Measure U taxes have been collected by the City of Hemet. Despite repeated calls for an independent audit of how the Measure U funds have been spent, we still don't know how the City of Hemet has managed to blow through $110,000,000 of taxpayer dollars while producing such meager results.

Here's what we do know: More than 70 employees at the City of Hemet now have an annual compensation package exceeding $300,000 with the highest exceeding $500,000; In the past 10 years, Hemet has had 11 City Managers (including the last one who recently resigned); In the previous three years, the individual salaries for the five City Council members have increased by 215%; The City recently spent nearly $2,000,000 to acquire property in Downtown Hemet for which there was no need; and, there are many more examples of mismanagement and negligence. WE DON'T HAVE A REVENUE PROBLEM - WE HAVE A SPENDING PROBLEM!

Now we're being asked to approve an additional 1% increase in the sales tax. If Measure Q passes, the City of Hemet sales tax rate would be 9.75% -- the highest of any city in the counties of Riverside, San Bernardino, Orange, San Diego, Ventura, and Imperial. INSANE!

Hemet voters need to send a clear message to City Hall, just like the voters in the Cities of Riverside, Loma Linda, and Encinitas have recently done - Increasing our sales tax is NOT the answer. Don't be misled by the propaganda coming out of Hemet City Hall and don't encourage or reward incompetence and mismanagement.

VOTE NO ON MEASURE Q.

By: James C. DePasse
Dalila Salcido
Norm Kyriss

REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE "Q"

The argument against Measure Q does not present the facts accurately.

We've done the research. The facts speak for themselves.

FACT: Measure U has been subject to independent citizens' oversight and annual reporting. Those reports are available to the public on the City's website: https://www.hemetca.gov/807/Measure-U-Citizen-Oversight-Committee.

FACT: In the last 5 years alone, Hemet has lost millions of dollars from continued state mandates and takeaways. Measure Q is legally required to stay right here in Hemet for our residents.

FACT: Having our own police and fire departments help ensure faster response times in an emergency. Drug trafficking and gang activity are serious problems in our area. Measure Q will provide funding to help maintain crime prevention services.

FACT: Hemet is controlling costs. The City has been fiscally responsible, reduced costs, frozen positions, and is using reserves to maintain services. There is no more room to cut without affecting critical services like public safety.

FACT: Measure Q helps address basic needs before they become more expensive, including repairing streets, fixing potholes, maintaining public areas, and supporting safe, clean drinking water.

FACT: Under Measure Q visitors, workers, shoppers, and everyone who makes taxable purchases in Hemet would help support the essential services that residents depend on.

CLEAR ACCOUNTABILITY: Measure Q requires Independent citizens' oversight and annual reports.

Essentials like groceries and medicine are exempt.

Measure Q is about maintaining the quality, safety and services Hemet residents deserve while ensuring clear accountability and transparency.

Quality Safety. Quality Services. Quality Hemet. Vote YES on Q!

By: Constance Howard-Clark
Linda E. Sutton
George Dickson Clark IV
James Welker
Jaculin Rae Peterson,
Hemet Council Member